LINNAEUS'S TWO-TOED SLOTH

A slow-moving mammal that lives in rainforest trees.

1 What can it see, hear, or feel?

Sharp hearing picks up tree movement, a keen nose finds food, and claws feel every branch firmly.

2 Where does it live — and why?

It lives high in the rainforest, hanging upside down, with green algae in its fur as camouflage.

3 How does it send messages?

It is mostly silent, but hisses when threatened, slashes with its claws, and stays still to hide.

4 What does it do when something changes?

When disturbed, it moves slowly into thicker leaves and holds still to stay out of sight.

5 How does it learn?

A young sloth clings to its mother for up to a year and learns which leaves to eat.

6 How does it have babies?

A mother has one baby while hanging upside down, and carries it everywhere she goes.

7 What are its limits?

It produces little body heat, so on the ground it is nearly helpless against predators.

8 What does this teach us?

Being slow and still is a real survival plan, not weakness — it fits the whole forest.

LOOK AT THE ANIMAL:

What do you see it doing right now?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.